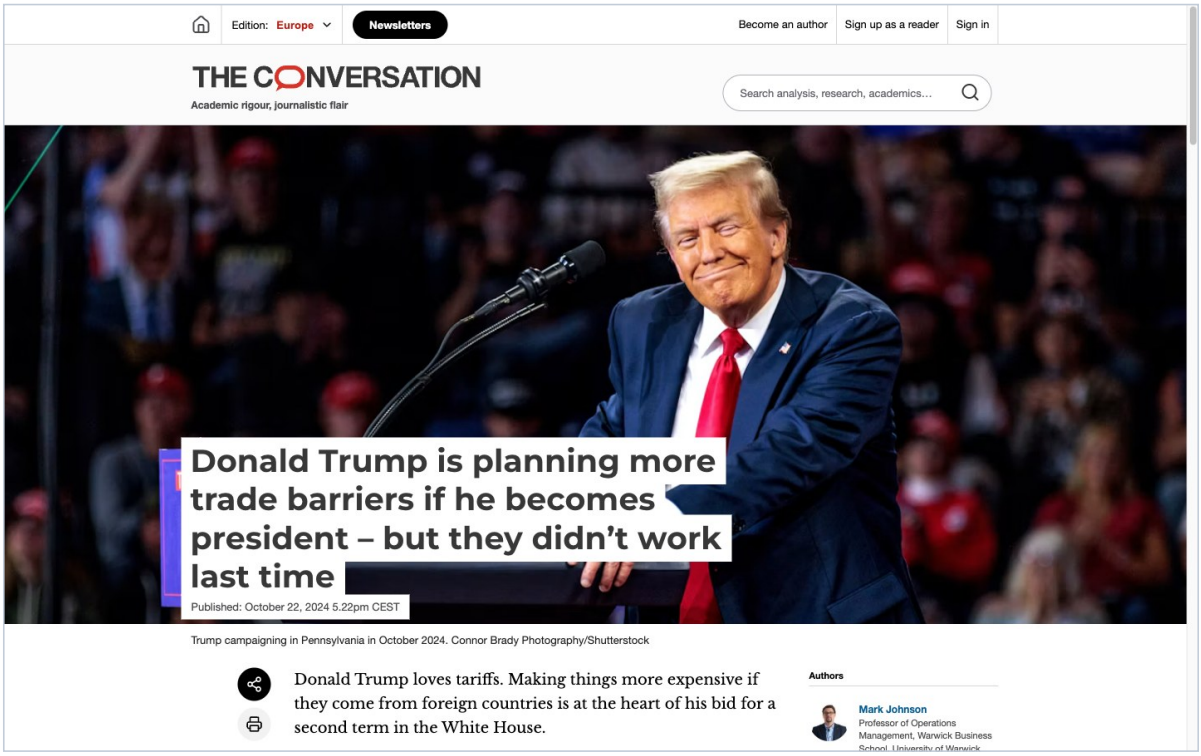
# The Conversation

*«Donald Trump is planning more trade barriers if he becomes president – but they didn't work last time»*

22 October 2024 · English · Article by co-authors Mark Johnson and Mehmet Chakkol on the study.

https://theconversation.com/donald-trump-is-planning-more-trade-barriers-if-he-becomes-president-but-they-didnt-work-last-time-240964

**Research.** Chakkol, M., Johnson, M., Karatzas, A., Papadopoulos, G. and Korfiatis, N. (2024). Making Supply Chains Great Again: Examining structural changes to US manufacturing supply chains. *International Journal of Operations and Production Management*, 44(5), 1083-1108.




imported steel and aluminium, to solar panels and washing machines.

But did they work? Our research suggests not.

In fact, we found that imposing tariffs actually made the US even more reliant on foreign suppliers – and failed to stimulate the domestic job market. They also raised costs for US consumers and provoked retaliatory tariffs from trading partners including China, the EU, Canada, Mexico, India and Turkey.

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China for example, responded by trebling tariffs on American cars. The EU filed a dispute with the World Trade Organisation and substantially raised tariffs on US exports including Harley Davidson motorcycles, jeans and bourbon whiskey.

And Trump's tariffs did not lead to a boost for US manufacturing either. After tariffs were imposed, our research shows US manufacturing supply chains evolved to have fewer suppliers – but it was often US firms that got forced out of those supply chains, not their competitors from overseas.

We found that US manufacturers appeared to reduce their global reach, while actually increasing their dependence on a select few foreign companies – further evidence that Trump's tariffs failed to produce the intended outcome.

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